STATE SCAN

TAMIL NADU: RAINBOW CABINET *PG 21*

DELHI: GYMKHANA LOOKS AT A CLOSED SIGN *PG 24*



HOLDING THE FUTURE
N. Chandrababu Naidu wants Andhraites to have more children

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▶ ANDHRA PRADESH

IMAGINING A 'FERTILE' ANDHRA

Naidu plots another boom—this time, of babies. A greying demography prompts a policy to reverse the population story

By **Prasad Nichenametla**

INVESTING IN THE FUTURE HAS ALWAYS BEEN N. CHANDRABABU NAIDU'S style, but till now, that has entailed technology—not biology. Naidu 4.0, however, ventures where no population policy has gone before: encouraging people to have more children. On May 16, the Andhra Pradesh chief minister went public with what he's been hinting at for long, a scheme called 'Pillale Sampada' (Children Are Wealth). That's literal. Families will get cash incentives of Rs 30,000 for a third child and Rs 40,000 for a fourth.

The message will soon be megaphoned at the micro-level—*gram sabhas* (village councils) and other forums—with consultations planned to gauge public opinion. To make sure Andhraites heed the CM's call, all manner of incentives are being lumped together into one integrated suite: a Rs 1,000 monthly nutrition support for five years under Poshana, free education till 18 years under Shiksha, and household health insurance support offering Suraksha (security), with year-long maternity leave and two-month paternity leave adding to the proffered com-